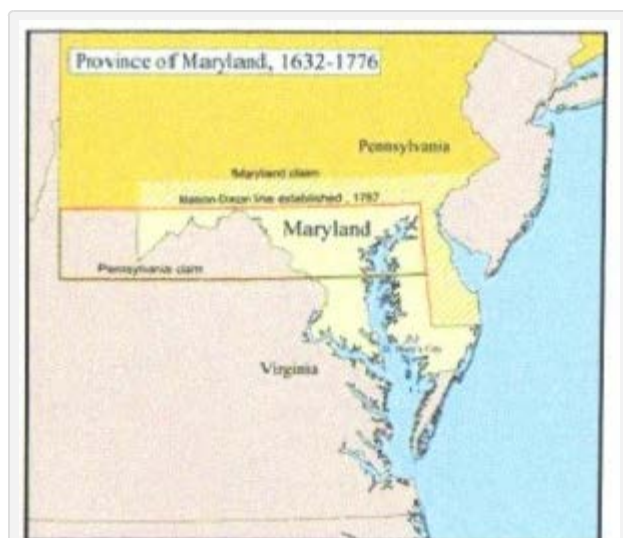




The Point of Beginning

Another little known but importance part of American history near [Georgetown](#) was the Point of Beginning. The Point of Beginning was associated with the Rittenhouse and Elliot survey marking the point directly across the river from [Georgetown](#) of the western boundary of PA and the south east corner of the Northwest Territory. This mark was the starting point for the survey of all public land west including Alaska, excluding the thirteen original colonies, Texas, and Hawaii. Chaired by Thomas Jefferson, The Land Ordinance Act of 1785 has been called the greatest subdivision of land on Earth. The spot is also registered among our National Historic Landmarks.



Pt of Beginning Courtesy of Wikipedia

was conducted between 1763 and 1767. Both Mason and Dixon returned to England when their westward progress was stopped by the threat of Indian attack.

The western boundary of PA was not established by the Mason-Dixon Line. Disputes continued. VA and PA continued to contest the land south of the Ohio River and west of the Youghiogheny River. As part of the Land Ordinance Act of 1785, the government of VA financed a survey of the western boundary of PA. The survey was completed on Aug 23,

In order to settle eighteenth century border disputes between PA and MD, PA and VA, and MD and DE, a survey was ordered by the British Crown. The surveyors were Charles Mason and Jeremiah Dixon and their work has become known as the Mason-Dixon Line symbolizing the cultural boundary between the North and the South. The survey

Search Pages and Posts

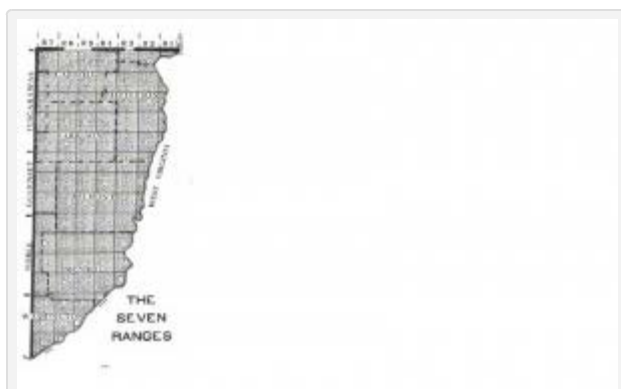
Biographical Data and Tales

- » [Site Introduction](#)
- » [Site Rules](#)
- » [About me](#)
- » [No Place for a Lady](#)
- » [NPE Journal Segment 1](#)
- » [NPE Journal Segment 2](#)
- » [It Used To Be A River Town](#)
- » [History in Homes](#)
 - » [The Lost Frontier Fort](#)
 - » [The Indian Fighters](#)
- » [The Circuit Rider](#)
- » [The Body](#)
- » [The Mercy Mission](#)
- » [The Ride](#)
- » [The Preacher's Note](#)
- » [The Game](#)
- » [The Point of Beginning](#)
- » [The Indian Rocks](#)
- » [The People of Georgetown](#)
 - » [Lillian May Poe](#)
 - » [EB Hawkins' Letters](#)
 - » [Artist Andrew Jackson Poe](#)
 - » [Gentleman Charles E Poe](#)
 - » [Parthenia Parr Calhoon](#)
 - » [Autograph Book 1878](#)
 - » [Floral Album 1878](#)
- » [Golden Age of Steamboats](#)
- » [Steamer Officer Biographies](#)
 - » [Capt Jacob Poe](#)
 - » [Capt Adam W Poe](#)
 - » [River Experiences](#)
 - » [Index of Names](#)
 - » [Capt Thomas W Poe](#)
 - » [Capt George WE Poe](#)
 - » [Capt George W Ebert](#)
 - » [Capt Richard Calhoon](#)
 - » [Capt Thomas S Calhoon](#)
 - » [Capt Jackman T Stockdale](#)
 - » [Capt Andrew Hague Parr](#)
 - » [Capt Benjamin M Laughlin](#)

1785. Like the Mason Dixon Line, there were two lead surveyors: David Rittenhouse from PA and Andrew Ellicott from VA, but the boundary has become known historically as the Ellicott Line.

Timbermen and stonemasons traveled with the surveyors. A path twenty feet wide was cleared and stones carved with a "P" on the east and a "V" on the west were set on every hilltop along the western border. The last marker was placed on the river bank just down river from Georgetown where the western border line of PA entered the Ohio River. Next to that marker is another cut stone survey marker that was installed in 1881. Both markers are on private property owned by First Energy. Permission must be obtained to visit these national treasures.

The Point of Beginning marker was set near the Ohio River opposite [Georgetown](#). It has been lost, probably to the rise in the river level due to the canalization of the Ohio.



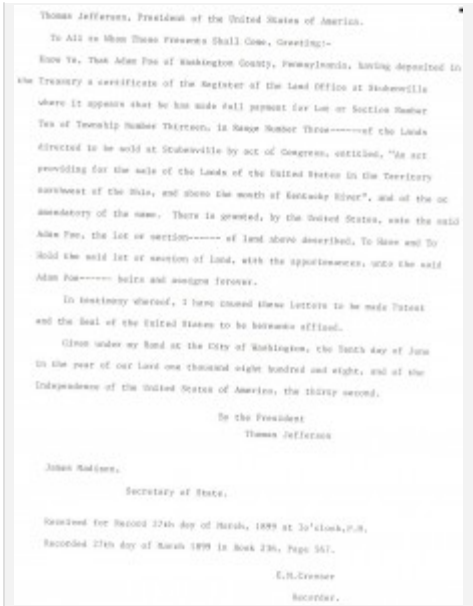
en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Seven_Ranges_Terminus

The Land Ordinance of 1785 also ordered that public land surveys were required before any land could be sold in the Northwest Territory. Thomas Hutchins was appointed the Geographer of the US and was to be assisted by thirteen surveyors, one per state. The instructions from Congress required the Geographer to run a line west from the Point of Beginning. At six mile intervals, called ranges and marked with a stone monument, another line was required to run due south to the Ohio River. The line west became known as the Geographer's Line. Hutchins and his team of surveyors began their work on 30 Sep 1785. After four miles the Public Land Surveys were suspended, like Mason and Dixon, because Hutchins received word that he would be attacked by Indians.

Long time [Georgetown](#) resident and pioneer surveyor, John Bever, surveyed Range Number 3 beginning in Sep 1799. His maps according to Ohio historian Thomas J Malone were "extremely interesting for their detail and the field notes that accompany them". [2] The land sold slowly due to the presence of illegal settlers and continued threat of Indian attacks.

On 10 Jun 1808 Adam Poe, the Indian fighter, purchased Lot or Section Number Ten of Township Number Thirteen in

- » [The BM Laughlin Book](#)
- » [The Book p1-43](#)
- » [The Book p45-85](#)
- » [The Book p87-125](#)
- » [The Book p127-163](#)
- » [The Book p165-205](#)
- » [The Book p207-294](#)
- » [BML v Lytle-Holdcamper](#)
- » [Re-discovered Steamers](#)
- » [Living Cpts and Pilots](#)
- » [Masters and Pilots Licenses](#)
- » [Steamer Biographies](#)
- » [Str Amelia Poe](#)
- » [Str Argyle](#)
- » [Str Barranquilla](#)
- » [Str Belfast](#)
- » [Str Belmont](#)
- » [Str Big Foot](#)
- » [Str Buckeye State](#)
- » [Str Clara Poe](#)
- » [The Case for Indemnity](#)
- » [Str Ella](#)
- » [Str Georgetown](#)
- » [Str Glencoe](#)
- » [Str Horizon](#)
- » [The Case for Indemnity](#)
- » [Str Katie Stockdale](#)
- » [Str Kenton](#)
- » [Str Leonora](#)
- » [Str Mollie Ebert](#)
- » [Str Neptune](#)
- » [Str Nick Wall](#)
- » [Str Sallie](#)
- » [Str Virginia](#)
- » [Str Yorktown](#)
- » [Georgetown Steamer File](#)
- » [Packet Lines Biographies](#)
- » [Pitt and Cin Packet Line](#)
- » [Luxury Packets](#)
- » [Old Pitt-Cin Packet Line](#)
- » [Missouri River Commerce](#)
- » [Georgetown Packets](#)
- » [TS Calhoon's Book 1866](#)
- » [TS Calhoon's Diary 1869](#)
- » [Blackfeet Nation in 1869](#)
- » [Photo and Image Galleries](#)
- » [Steamboat Memorabilia](#)
- » [Nash Steamboat Images](#)
- » [Nash Steamboat Postcards](#)
- » [Georgetown Views](#)
- » [Victorian Death Notifications](#)
- » [Lillian May Poe Photos](#)
- » [Churches, Schoools, etc](#)
- » [Poe Glass Plate Negatives](#)
- » [Indian Rocks](#)
- » [Point of Beginning Photos](#)
- » [Maps and Deeds](#)
- » [Catalogue of Deeds](#)
- » [Lots 19&20 1833](#)
- » [Lots 19&20 1850](#)
- » [Lot 21 1804](#)



Adam Poe Range 3 Land in Ohio
(Transcription by unknown)



Collection of F Nash 2011)

Range Number Three.

The historical monument marking the Point of Beginning was erected in a roadside park by the PA DOT exactly 1,112 feet from the original stake near the river shore.[\[1\]](#)

- » [Lot 21 1850](#)
- » [Poe Wood 1850](#)
- » [Map 17 Dec 1847](#)
- » [Map 1876](#)
- » [Letters and Papers](#)
- » [Ltr WH Turner](#)
- » [Ltrs Jacob Poe](#)
- » [Ltrs William A Calhoun](#)
- » [Ltr Adam Poe 22 Mar 1849](#)
- » [Georgetown Methodist Church](#)
- » [St Luke's Episcopal Church](#)
- » [Georgetown Cemetery](#)
- » [Georgetown Cemetery File](#)
- » [Steamboating Poe Ancestry](#)
- » [Value of the US Dollar](#)
- » [Recommended Reading List](#)
- » [Acknowledgements](#)

Archives

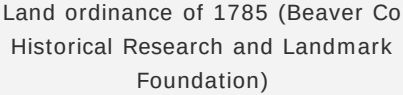
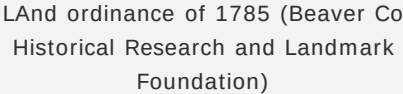
Select Month

Categories

- » [Civil War Steamers](#)
- » [History of Georgetown PA](#)
- » [Missouri River Commerce](#)
- » [River history](#)
- » [River Museums](#)
- » [River Tales](#)
- » [Steamer Captains](#)
- » [Uncategorized](#)

Museums / Libraries / Blogs

- » [GeorgetownSteamboats on Facebook](#)
- » [Lancaster at War](#)
- » [Museum of Ceramics](#)
- » [Public Library of Cincinnati and Hamilton County](#)
- » [Sons and Daughters of Pioneer Rivermen](#)
- » [Steamboat Building at Elizabeth, PA](#)
- » [Ten Mile Creek Country](#)
- » [UW LaCrosse Historic Steamboat Photographs](#)



[1] Denver and Eugenia Walton and Bob Bauder, *Rivers of Destiny*,

Beaver county Historical and Landmarks Foundation, 1999, pg 67-68.

[2] Thomas J Malone, *John Bever, Pioneer Surveyor*, East Liverpool Historical Society, 1975, p 31.

Copyright © 2011 Francis W Nash
All Rights Reserved

Georgetown Steamboats is proudly powered by [WordPress](#)
[Entries \(RSS\)](#) and [Comments \(RSS\)](#).